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Chairs of the IEEE RAS Technical Committee on Cognitive Robotics

Dear Chairs of the Technical Committee on Cognitive Robotics,

Re: Financial support request for the IROS 2026 workshop, *Compositional and Modular Learning in the Era of Scaling in Robotics*

On behalf of the organizing committee, we respectfully request financial support from the IEEE RAS Technical Committee on Cognitive Robotics for our workshop, *Compositional and Modular Learning in the Era of Scaling in Robotics*, to be held in conjunction with the IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS 2026), on September 27, 2026, in Pittsburgh, PA, USA.

As robot learning systems continue to scale, an important question is how complex and generalizable robotic capabilities can be constructed from reusable, specialized, and interpretable components. Our workshop will bring together researchers working on compositional learning, modular robot architectures, foundation models, perception, planning, control, and generalization. These topics are closely aligned with the mission of the Technical Committee on Cognitive Robotics, particularly its interest in robotic systems that integrate perception, reasoning, learning, and action.

The primary purpose of the requested support is to make the workshop more accessible to students and early-career researchers who may not have sufficient travel or institutional funding. In particular, the funding would be used for:

- travel grants for students and early-career researchers;
- registration fee waivers for students with limited financial support;
- travel and lodging support for invited speakers, as funding permits.

Enabling student participation will substantially strengthen the workshop, allowing junior researchers to present their work, receive feedback from experts, and establish collaborations across the cognitive robotics and robot learning communities.

We respectfully request financial support in the amount of **five hundred US dollars ($500)**. If the full amount is not available, support at any level would be sincerely appreciated and would be prioritized toward student travel grants and registration assistance. All funding decisions and reimbursements would be handled transparently and in accordance with IEEE and conference policies.

The support of the Technical Committee would help us create an inclusive and intellectually engaging workshop. We would gratefully acknowledge the Committee's support on the workshop website, in the program, and during the opening and closing remarks.

Thank you very much for considering our request.

Sincerely,

Haonan Chen
On behalf of the Workshop
Organizing Committee
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